

SENATE No. 1770

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Bruce E. Tarr

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to safety of officers by requiring interior lights in automobiles to be on during stops.

PETITION OF:

NAME:

Bruce E. Tarr

DISTRICT/ADDRESS:

First Essex and Middlesex

SENATE No. 1770

By Mr. Tarr, a petition (accompanied by bill, Senate, No. 1770) of Bruce E. Tarr for legislation relative to safety of officers by requiring interior lights in automobiles to be on during stops. Public Safety and Homeland Security.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE SENATE, NO. 1588 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to safety of officers by requiring interior lights in automobiles to be on during stops.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 90, of the General Laws shall be amended by adding after section 62 the new
2 section 63, the following:-

3 “Section 63. (a) When a motor vehicle is stopped by a police officer as defined in section
4 98 of chapter 41 of the general laws, the operator shall immediately activate interior cabin
5 lighting if present and operational, and illuminate the inside of the vehicle.

6 (b) If the operator does not immediately activate interior cabin lighting, the officer may
7 order the operator to comply with this requirement. Noncompliance with such an order shall be
8 considered a violation of section 25 of this chapter.”